



Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church Sunday School Department
Mahibere Kidusan North America Center
Campus Ministry

In the name of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit . One God, Amen!

Dogmatic Theology

2020-21

Semester 2



<https://eotcmk.org>

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Mystery of Baptism



Mystery of Baptism

- The Mystery of Baptism is the teaching that a person receives the invisible grace of childhood by a second birth from the Holy Spirit, through the visible rite of baptism in water in the name of the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit.

*“Except a man be born of water and of the Spirit, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God.” **John 3:5***

*“Make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit.” **Matt. 28:19***

- A saving sacrament



Mystery of Baptism

- Baptism the entry into a life of Christianity.
- As our path in life in this world starts at birth from our mother's womb, our path in salvation also starts with the second birth, which is baptism.
(John 3:3) That is why baptism is the first sacrament administered to new believers since the apostolic era. **(Acts 2:41; 8:12; 8:36-38; 9:18; 18:18; 19:5)**
 - We can't partake of the other six sacraments without being baptized first.
 - *"Repent and be baptized."* **Acts 2:38**
 - *"When they believed Philip preaching the things concerning the kingdom of God, and the name of Jesus Christ, they were baptized."* **Acts 8:12**
 - *"Here is water, what prevents me from being baptized?"* **Acts 8:36**
 - *"Many of the Corinthians who heard Paul believed and were baptized."* **Acts 18:8**



Mystery of Baptism

- Through Baptism we become the children of God
 - *“You received the Spirit of adoption, whereby you cry Abba, Father.” **Rom 8:15***
- And thus heirs to His Kingdom.
 - *“Unless one is born again, He cannot see the Kingdom of God.” **John 3:3***
 - *“For as many of you as were baptized into Christ have put on Christ . . . And if you are Christ’s, then you are Abraham’s seed, and heirs according to the promise.” **(Gal 3:27-29)***
- *Baptism is the door into a life of discipleship in our Lord Jesus Christ:*
 - *“Make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit.” **(Matthew 28:19)***



Mystery of Baptism

The importance of Baptism:

- Salvation

“ . . . In the days of Noah, while the ark was being prepared, in which a few, that is, eight souls, were saved through water. There is also an antitype which now saves us—baptism . . . ” (1 Peter 3:20-21)

“ . . . All our fathers were under the cloud, all passed through the sea, all were baptized into Moses in the cloud and in the sea . . . ” (1 Corinthians 10:1-2)

- Partaking in His suffering and death:

“Do you not know that as many of us as were baptized into Christ Jesus were baptized into His death?” (Romans 6:3)

“ . . . Buried with Him in baptism, in which you also were raised with Him . . . ” (Colossians 2:12)



Mystery of Baptism

Baptism of the Lord Jesus Christ

- To reveal the Trinity (**Matthew 3:16-17**)
- To set an example for us.
 - **John 3:3** – “Unless a man is born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God.
 - **John 13:15** – “I have given you an example, that you should see how I have done to you.”
 - **1 Peter 2:21** – “Christ also suffered for us, leaving us an example, that you should follow His steps.”
- To set an example of humility
 - **1 Peter 2:21** – “Christ also suffered for us, leaving us an example, that you should follow His steps.”



Mystery of Baptism

Baptism of the Lord Jesus Christ

- To fulfil the prophecy:
 - Psalm 77:16 – “The waters saw you, O God, the waters saw you; they were afraid; the depths were also troubled.”
 - Psalm 114:5 – *“What ailed you, O thou sea, that you fled? Thou Jordan, that you were driven back.”*
- The Jordan River
 - Joshua 3 – The Israelites pass through dry land after “the waters that came down from above” was cut off when the priests carrying the Ark set foot in the river.



Mystery of Baptism

- Symbols of Baptism
 - The Baptism of Naaman /**2 Kings 5**/
 - Irenaeus: “It was not for nothing that Naaman of old, when suffering from leprosy, was purified upon being baptized, but it served as an indication to us. For as we are lepers in sin, we are made clean, by means of the sacred water and the invocation of the Lord, from our old transgressions.”*
 - The Ark of Noah
 - The Red Sea the Israelites passed through (**1 Corinthians 10:1-2**)
 - Circumcision / **Col. 2:11-12**/



Mystery of Baptism

- The water with which we are baptized is not merely water like the one John the Baptist was baptizing with, but Divine.
 - *“I indeed baptize you with water unto repentance, but He who is coming after me is mightier than I, whose sandals I am not worthy to bear. He shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost and with fire.” /Matt. 3:11/*
- Baptism is done by immersion. The child or the person being baptized is immersed in the water three times, to symbolize our death and resurrection with Jesus Christ. (*Romans 6:3; Colossians 2:12*)
- Through this visible rite, the person baptized receives the invisible grace of childhood to God.



Mystery of Baptism

Infant Baptism

- Boys are baptized 40 days after birth and girls, 80 days after birth according to God's instruction of cleansing period for the mother. (Leviticus 12:1-8)
- Children, born of Christians are not considered unbelieving. God's covenant with Abraham and His descendants to circumcise every male in his household, including newborns on the eighth day, was a sign of the covenant between God and Abraham, and a sign of the faith in the Lord God. (Genesis 17)



Mystery of Baptism

Infant Baptism

- Baptism is a gift.
 - Acts 2:38 – 39: *“Repent and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins, and you shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost.”*
- The promise of Baptism includes children.
 - Acts 2:39 *“For the promise is unto you and to your children.”*
- Children should not be rejected from this gift/grace of God
 - Luke 18:15–16: *“Now they were bringing even infants to him that he might touch them; and when the disciples saw it, they rebuked them. But Jesus called them to him, saying, ‘Let the children come to me, and do not hinder them; for to such belongs the kingdom of God’”*



Mystery of Baptism

Infant Baptism

- Circumcision as a symbol of faith
 - Col. 2:11-12: *“In whom also you are circumcised with the circumcision made without hands, in putting off the body of sins of the flesh by the circumcision of Christ. Buried with Him in baptism, wherein also you are risen with him...”*
 - Gen. 17:11-12 *“And you shall circumcise the flesh of your foreskin and it shall **be a token of the covenant between me and you.** And he that is **eight days old** shall be circumcised among you...”*
- Baptism of Children was practiced during the apostolic period
 - Acts 16:15 – *“And when she (Lydia) was baptized, and her household, she besought us, saying, if you have judge me to be faithful to the Lord, come into my house and abide there.”*
 - 1 Cor. 1:16 *“I did baptize also the household of Stephanas”*

